

March 13, 2026

Hiring Committee
Charles River Associates

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Senior Associate position at Charles River Associates. I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University and expect to complete my degree in May 2026. My research focuses on quantitative economic analysis, macroeconomic modeling, and empirical methods, and I am excited about the opportunity to apply these analytical tools to complex real-world problems in an economic consulting environment.

My academic research combines theoretical modeling with empirical analysis using large datasets. In my job market paper, I develop a heterogeneous-agent life-cycle model to study wealth accumulation and inequality, incorporating differences in returns to wealth and income risk. This project required building computational models, conducting econometric analysis, and working extensively with microeconomic datasets using Python and Stata. Through this work I have developed strong experience translating complex economic models and empirical results into clear analytical insights.

Beyond my dissertation research, I have significant experience communicating technical concepts to diverse audiences. As a teaching assistant for courses in data-driven and quantitative finance, I worked closely with students to explain economic models, empirical methods, and data analysis techniques. These experiences strengthened my ability to present technical ideas clearly—an ability that I believe is essential in consulting environments where analytical findings must be communicated effectively to clients, attorneys, and policymakers.

I am particularly interested in CRA's work in Antitrust and Competition Economics and Energy, where rigorous economic analysis is used to inform high-stakes litigation and policy decisions. I am drawn to CRA's reputation for combining academic rigor with practical, data-driven insights and for collaborating closely with leading academics, regulators, and industry experts. My preferred locations are Chicago or Washington, DC, though I would be happy to be considered for other offices as well.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my quantitative research skills, collaborative approach, and intellectual curiosity to CRA's project teams. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards